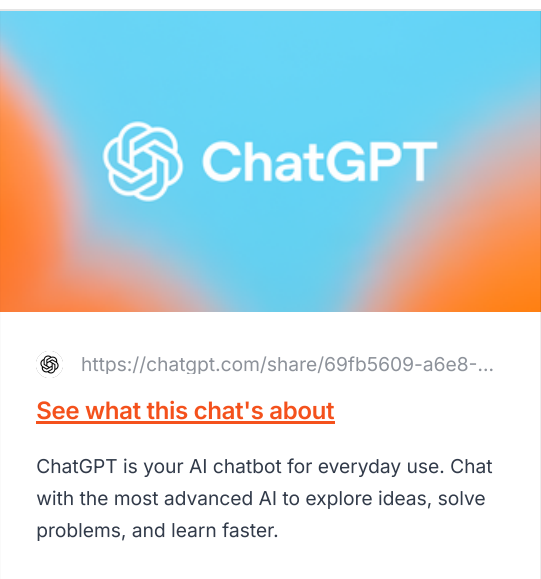




Below is a clean version you can paste into your **Command Center** → **Information Interactions** section.

Information Interaction #1

Source / Input

Title: *AutoStory: Generating Diverse Storytelling Images with Minimal Human Effort*
Creator / Organization: Wen Wang, Canyu Zhao, Hao Chen, Zhekai Chen, Kecheng Zheng, Chunhua Shen
Link: <https://arxiv.org/abs/2404.02311v2>
Source Type: Research paper / AI story visualization study

Why it matters:

This source matters because it focuses on turning story text into a series of connected images. That connects directly to AI-assisted comic and webcomic creation because comics need repeated characters, clear panel flow, scene layout, and visual consistency. The paper is useful for my project because it shows AI as part of a workflow instead of just a tool that makes random images.

Interaction

I read through the paper and focused on how AutoStory turns written stories into visual panels. I used AI to help break down the source into simpler project connections, especially around character consistency, panel planning, and where human control still matters.

The paper explains that story visualization needs images that are high quality, aligned with the text, and consistent across characters and scenes. That connects to comic creation because a comic does not work if the character changes every panel or if the image does not match the story.

Research Artifact 1: AI Questions About the Source

Question 1

How does this source connect to comic creation?

Answer:
It connects because AutoStory is about generating a sequence of story images from text. Comics and webcomics also rely on sequences of images, not just single illustrations.

Question 2

What part of the comic process does AI help with?

Answer:
AI can help with breaking a story into panels, creating rough image prompts, planning layouts, and generating visual drafts.

Question 3

What is the biggest issue this source connects to?

Answer:
The biggest issue is character consistency. Comics need the same character to stay visually recognizable across multiple panels.

Question 4

Where does the artist/designer still need control?

Answer:
The artist still needs to control the story, pacing, panel composition, character design, style rules, and final edits.

Question 5

How does this affect my project direction?

Answer:
It shows that my project should focus less on "AI can make comics" and more on "AI can support a comic-making workflow."

Research Artifact 2: Workflow Diagram

```
graph TD
    A[Story idea] --> B[Break story into panels]
    B --> C[Write panel descriptions]
    C --> D[Plan character/object placement]
    D --> E[Generate AI image drafts]
    E --> F[Check character consistency]
    F --> G[Fix layout, style, and story issues]
    G --> H[Human edit / redesign]
    H --> I[Final comic or webcomic layout]
```

Notes

- AI helps with rough structure and visual testing.
- AI can speed up early comic ideas.
- AI still needs strong direction.
- The artist/designer decides what stays, what changes, and what gets rejected.
- Character consistency is one of the biggest things to test.

Key Finding

The main thing I learned is that AI-assisted comic creation works better as a **workflow** than as a one-click comic generator. AutoStory uses AI to help break a story into visual panels, plan the layout, and generate connected story images. The paper also shows that keeping characters consistent across multiple images is a major part of making AI storytelling actually useful.

Verification

I verified that the source is not just about making single AI images. It is specifically about **story visualization**, which means generating a series of images that match a story. The paper says the images need to match the text, look good, and keep character identities consistent across different images.

I also questioned the idea that this removes the need for human effort completely. Even though the system reduces manual work, a comic artist or designer would still need to check the story flow, character design, layout, pacing, and final quality.

Visual / Process Notes

For my visual/process notes, I would create a Figma or notebook page with this structure:

```
graph TD
    A[AI Comic Workflow Map] --> B[Story]
    B --> C[Panel Split]
    C --> D[Layout Planning]
    D --> E[Character Consistency]
    E --> F[AI Draft Images]
    F --> G[Human Review]
    G --> H[Comic Layout]
```

Add these labels around the map:

Where AI helps:

- turning story into panel ideas
- rough image generation
- layout planning
- style testing
- visual brainstorming

Where AI struggles:

- keeping characters perfectly consistent
- clear storytelling
- exact poses
- emotional expression
- panel-to-panel continuity

Where the human steps in:

- story decisions
- final layout
- editing
- style rules
- rejecting bad outputs
- fixing consistency problems

Evidence

The paper's example images show multiple story panels created from text and character inputs. The paper describes AutoStory as a method for generating "text-aligned, identity-consistent, and high-quality story images" from user-input stories and characters.

A useful evidence screenshot would be:

“Page 1 or Page 9 from the PDF, because both show examples of generated storytelling images across multiple panels.”

Reflection

This source helped me understand that AI-assisted comic creation is not just about making one cool image. Comics and webcomics depend on a sequence of images that have to connect through story, layout, characters, and pacing. AutoStory is useful for my project because it shows how AI can take a story and help turn it into visual panels while trying to keep the characters and scenes consistent.

What AI helped me see is that the comic process can be broken into steps: story, panel descriptions, layout planning, image generation, consistency checking, and final editing. What I had to question is the idea that AI removes most of the human work. It may reduce some effort, but it does not replace the artist or designer. The human still has to decide if the story makes sense, if the panels flow correctly, if the character looks right, and if the final comic actually works.

This changes my project direction by making it more workflow-focused. Instead of asking whether AI can make comics, I want to focus on how AI can support comic creation without removing creative control. My next move is to test a small comic workflow myself using one character, one short scene, and a few panel prompts to see where AI helps and where it breaks.

Project / Product Implication

This source pushes my project toward becoming an **AI-assisted comic creation workflow guide**. The final product could show artists and designers how to use AI for story ideas, panel planning, character testing, and rough drafts while still keeping human control over the final comic.

Next Move

My next move is to run a small test:

```
Create one character.
Write a short 3-panel scene.
Use the same character description in each prompt.
Generate or mock up three panels.
Compare what stays consistent and what changes.
Write down what AI helped with and what needed human correction.
```

This will give me my own project evidence instead of only relying on the paper.

This source helps my project because it shows that AI-assisted comic creation is not just about generating random images. It is about building a process where the story gets broken into panels, the characters stay consistent, and the layout supports the scene. AutoStory connects to my project because comics and webcomics depend on visual storytelling across multiple panels. The source also shows that AI can help with planning and rough image generation, but human judgment is still needed to control pacing, style, character design, and final edits.

Simple breakdown: how this PDF helps your AI comic project

This PDF helps because it is basically about turning **story text into a series of connected images**. That is very close to how comics and webcomics work. A comic is not just one cool image. It needs panels, repeated characters, clear scenes, and visual flow.

Main idea from the PDF

The paper is about **AutoStory**, a system that generates storytelling images from text with less human effort. It focuses on three things that matter a lot for comics:

What the PDF talks aboutWhy it matters for comics**Story visualization**Comics are visual stories, so this connects directly.**Panel-by-panel image generation**It breaks a story into separate images, almost like comic panels.**Character consistency**Comics need the same character to look like the same person across panels.**Layout planning**Comic panels need characters and objects placed clearly.**Human control**The system still allows users to adjust layout, sketches, poses, and images.

How this helps your project

This source supports your idea that AI can help with comic creation, but it should not be treated like the whole creator.

The PDF shows that AI can help with:

- turning a story into panel ideas
- planning where characters go in a scene
- generating rough visuals
- keeping characters more consistent
- testing different scenes or styles faster

But it also shows that comic creation still needs human control because the artist/designer has to decide:

- what the story is actually about
- how the panels flow
- what the character should look like
- whether the image matches the scene
- what needs to be edited or rejected

Best part to focus on

The strongest part for your assignment is **character consistency**.

The paper says story images need to be high quality, match the text, and keep character identities consistent across images. That is basically one of the biggest problems with using AI for comics.

How you could explain it in your project

Use something like this:

This source helps my project because it shows that AI-assisted comic creation is not just about generating random images. It is about build

Simple project connection

Your project could use this PDF to support this idea:

“AI can help build the rough structure of a comic, but the artist still needs to control the story, consistency, layout, and final design choices.”

That is probably the cleanest way this source helps your assignment.

